

WAN
Connects remote LANs via SPs for data/voice/video; key needs: bandwidth, control, design, resilience, mgmt. **Requirements:**
Bandwidth: Plan for normal load, peak usage, reserved capacity for VoIP
Control/Security: Reliance on the provider → encryption and segmentation
Availability: Use redundancy, diverse paths, SLAs to reduce outage impact
Management:
In-band: Manage devices over the production WAN
Out-of-band: Use separate management path for recovery/emergencies

PRIVATE WAN
Point-to-Point: Leased L2 line (Ethernet), monthly fee, private circuit, fast
Dark Fiber: Physical fiber lease, costly; ISPs prefer selling lambdas
Coarse Wavelength Division Multiplexing (CWDM): x16, cheaper, 120km, passive MUX, use mirrors to aggregate/separate signals (analog)
Dense Wavelength Division Multiplexing (DWDM): x80, 10GB/s, 1000km, active MUX, more precise, uses software "smarter", wideband
connection-oriented: Predefined path, packet IDs (ATM, Frame Relay)
Connectionless: No setup, full address in each packet (Ethernet, MPLS VPN)
Circuit-Switched: Requires signaling protocol to establish e2e circuit
Packet-Switched: Expects networks to know how to forward packets

PUBLIC WAN
Site-to-Site VPN: Fixed locations, devices locked to IP addr
Remote Access VPN: Changing locations, devices not locked to IP addr
Software-Defined WAN (SDWAN): connects LANs across large distances using controlling software that works with a variety of networking hardware.

MULTI PROTOCOL LABEL SWITCHING (MPLS)
– Advantage of eBGP at PE-CE: No mutual redistrib., same routing process
– Control plane (e.g. OSPF) → to learn labels
– iBGP to exchange NLRI (RD, RT, IPv4 Pref, Next-Hop & VPN Lb) between PE
– Traffic encrypted flowing over MPLS L3VPN backbone (e.g. Bank)

Label Switched Router (LSR): Forwarded labeled packets
Label Switched Path (LSP): Pre-determined path across MPLS network
Unicast Reverse Path Forwarding (uRPF): checks source of each packet & verifies that source is in routing table
imp-nul: networks are directly connected, no more label switching
Virtual Private Wire Service (VPWS): Pseudowire (PW); No MAC learning at PE level; P2P L2 VPN, allows two sites to connect as if directly linked
Virtual Private LAN Service (VPLS): Emulates LAN segment across MPLS backbone, provides multipoint L2 connectivity; MAC learning at the PE level

CONFIG
1) RIB entry to 10.3.3.0/24 is a next-hop IP address of 192.168.12.2
2) PE1 compares that entry to the list of interface IPs on each peer and finds nei with IP 192.168.12.2. The LDP ID (LID) of this peer is 2.2.2.2
3) PE1 notes that for 10.3.3.0, LID contains one local and two remote labels
4) Among the known labels, one was learned from 2.2.2.2, with label 22

PE1# show ip route 1 inc 10.3.3.0
1 10.3.3.0 [90/2835456] via 192.168.12.2, 00:05:08, Serial0/0/1/0
PE1#
PE1# show mpls ldp bindings 10.3.3.0 24
Lib entry: 10.3.3.0/24, rev 28
Local bindings: Lsr: 2.2.2.2, 0, label: 22
remote binding: Lsr: 4.4.4.4, 0, label: 86
PE1#
PE1# show mpls ldp nei 4
Peer LDP Ident: 2.2.2.2; Local LDP Ident 1.1.1.1;0
TCP connection: 2.2.2.2.2.34326 -> 1.1.1.1.6446
State: Oper; Hgss ssent/rcv: 37/33; Downstream
2 Up time: 0:02:57
LDP discovery sources:
Serial0/0/1, Src IP addr: 192.168.12.2
Addresses bound to LDP Ident: 1
1 192.168.12.2 2.2.2.2 192.168.12.0 192.168.24.0

ROUTER TYPES
Customer Edge (CE): No knowledge of MPLS, no labels; connected to **Provider Edge (PE):** On edge of MPLS net; runs BGP & LDP; uses VRFs
Provider or LSR (P): Inside MPLS VPN, no CE connection; forwards labels

DATABASES, PLANES
Control Plane: Builds routing/labeling (RIB, LID)
Data Plane: Forwards packets (FIB, LFIB); pushes/swaps/pops labels
Class of Service Forwarding (CoS): (Cisco) LFIB without labels → FIB? **Routing Information Base (RIB):** Learned prefixes from routing protocols
Forwarding IB (FIB): Built from RIB; only best routes for forwarding
Label IB (LIB): All label mappings; No BGP prefixes; 1 label per prefix
Label Forwarding IB (LFIB): Built from LIB; used for actual forwarding decisions. (LFIB only contains currently best LSP decision (Routing Protocol))

MPLS HEADER
4-byte header built by WI. With MPLS VPN, there will be a stack of two headers
Label IB: active MPLS labels
EXP (3b): CoS/QoS, Now called Traffic Class (TC)
S-bit (1b): Bottom of label stack indicator, 1 = True = last label before IP header
TTL (8b): time-to-live (equal to IP TTL)

TTL
– Ingress PE decrements IP TTL field & copies IP TTL field into new MPLS TTL
– P routers decrements MPLS TTL
– Egress PE decrements MPLS TTL, pops final MPLS header, copies IP TTL
– If provider doesn't want to expose MPLS network: disable **MPLS TTL propagation** on PE, PE sets MPLS TTL=255, egress PE leaves original IP TTL unchanged → new network appears as single router hop from TTL perspective

LABEL DISTRIBUTION PROTOCOL (LDP) - CONTROL PLANE
– Distributes labels to neighbors, triggered by new IP route in FIB
– **Hello messages** sent via UDP (Port 646) to 224.0.0.2 to discover neighbors
– TCP (646) connection used to exchange label bindings (prefix to local lib)
– Router advertises all local bindings after TCP session is up
– Label mapping used to build LIB → LFIB
– LDP router ID must be reachable (via routing table)
– Each router manages local labels independently
– Relies on underlying routing protocol for best route & loop prevention

MPLS L3 DATA PLANE
Outer label: Transport label (LDP); identifies LSP between ingress/egress PE
Inner label: Transport label (BGP); identifies customer VRF
Push: Ingress PE: classify and label packets
Swap: P router; replaces label, forwards based on new VRF
Pop: Egress PE removes label; sends original packet to CE
Penultimate Hop Popping (PHP): penultimate router removes the outer MPLS label before forwarding to egress PE, default enabled, ISPs disable it

VIRTUAL ROUTING AND FORWARDING (VRF) TABLES
– Virtual router inside a PE. Maintains isolated RIB + FIB and separate routing process per CE (VPN isolation)
– Exists per MPLS-aware PE router; one per attached customer

ROUTE DISTINGUISHER (RD) VS. ROUTE TARGET (RT)
Route Distinguisher (RD): *Uniquely identifies* VPN routes (per VRF) → allows same IP prefix to be used in different VPNs. Can be IPv4 or ASN.
– **Form:** VPNv4 NLRI (MP-BGP): RD-IPv4 prefix (12 bytes: RD 8b, IP 4b)
Route Target (RT): Controls route **import/export** between VRFs. Used as **extended BGP community path attributes**. Typically in the form **ASN:nn** or **IP:nn**, e.g., 65000:100, 1:10
How RTs Work: Route is tagged with an RT when advertised by BGP. Other VRFs import the route if the RT matches their import policy. Allows overlapping or shared connectivity between tenants (e.g., shared services).

OVERLAY TECHNOLOGIES
Overlay network (virtual) sits on top of the **underlay network** (physical).
Generic Routing Encapsulation (GRE): Encapsulates data packets, unencrypted, P2P. Enables usage of unsupported protocols. Carries passenger protocol/original packet inside carrier/transport IP header routed by underlay

SEGMENT ROUTING (SR)
Source routing: Sender defines full path using Segment (= Instruction) List
Segment Identifier (SID): Each SID = 1 instruction (e.g., forward via ECMP, specific face, or to a service)
Segment List: Ordered SID list carried in packet header; defines full route
State in packet: No per-flow state, intermediate nodes follow SID instructions
No new control plane: Uses existing protocols (OSPF, IS-IS, BGP) with extensions; no LDP or RSVP-TE needed
Data plane: Can operate over MPLS or IPv6
Simple but powerful: Enables TE, fast reroute, policy routing

SEGMENT LIST OPERATIONS
Push: Insert SIDs into packet; set active SID (top of list)
Continue: Active SID not yet completed; keep processing it
Next: Current SID completed; activate next SID in list

SEGMENT SIGNIFICANCE
Global Segments: Known and supported by all SR nodes in the domain, installed in forwarding tables across the network (e.g., "Forward packet according to shortest path to Node1"). Defined in the SR Global Block (SRGB) and should be consistent across all nodes
Local Segments: Defined and installed only on originating node, not forwarded by others, but must be understood network-wide (e.g., "Forward packet on interface to Node2"). Defined in the SR Local Block (SRLB) and are specific to the local SR node.

CONTROL PLANE SEGMENT TYPES
IGP Prefix Segment: Global SID tied to IGP prefix (multi-hop); all nodes install forwarding entries: "steer traffic along ECMP-aware shortest path"
IGP Node Segment: Global SID for a specific node (shortest-path forwarding)
IGP Adjacency Segment: Local SID for a specific link; traffic sent to nearest IGP Adjacency Segment
L2 Adjacency SID: Local SID for Layer-2 segment (e.g., Ethernet link)
Combining Segments: End-to-end paths can mix IGP and BGP segments. Traffic to BGP Anycast → more ECMP in data centers

SR-MPLS
– Reuses existing MPLS data plane; no hardware change needed
– Segments = MPLS labels; Segment List = label stack (top = active)
– Segments distributed via IGP/BGP; no LDP necessary (but possible)
– Supports both IPv4 and IPv6 networks
– PUSH= PUSH, CONTINUE= SWAP, NEXT= POP

BENEFITS OF SEGMENT ROUTING
Benefits: Simplification (removes protocols, simple operations, admin and mgmt), enhanced Traffic eng. (Delay, Bandwidth, Packet Loss, TE metric, Controller, Source-Node), Seamless deployment, Robust
Source Routing: Labels distributed inline with centralized optimization
Traffic Engineering (TE): Optimizes network performance by analyzing and controlling data flow to reduce congestion and improve QoS

DRAWBACKS OF TRADITIONAL NETWORKS
Control Plane: LDP/RSVP-TE adds complexity
Scalability: Per-flow/path limits growth; LSP, signaling overhead increase fast

VIRTUAL EXTENSIBLE LOCAL AREA NETWORK (VXLAN)
Data plane technology which encapsulates Ethernet frames in UDP data packets to tunnel layer 2 frames over a layer 3 network. The underlay network is unaware of the overlay.
Issues of L2: STP. Max amount of VLANs (4094). Large MAC Address tables
VXLAN: Tunnels Ethernet (Layer 2) over IP using MAC-in-UDP encapsulation (Port 4789). For flexible and scalable network segmentation.
VXLAN Identifier (VNI): 24-bit identifier (Up to 16 million segments) that defines the VXLAN broadcast domain.
Virtual Tunnel Endpoint (VTEP): Device (switch, router, or host) responsible for encapsulating/de-encapsulating VXLAN traffic.
Network Virtual Interface (NVE): Logical interface on a VTEP used for VXLAN tunnel operations.

FRAME FORMAT
– Original Ethernet frame → VXLAN Header → UDP → Outer IP Header
– The VXLAN header contains the 24-bit VNI and flags.
– Outer headers allow Layer 2 frames to traverse IP underlay networks.

VIRTUAL NETWORK IDENTIFIER (VNI)
– 24-bit VXLAN Network Identifier uniquely defines VXLAN segments.
– Replaces traditional VLAN IDs (12-bit)
– Used by VTEPs to map traffic into corresponding Layer 2 domains.

VXLAN TUNNEL ENDPOINT (VTEP)
Connects the overlay (VXLAN) and underlay (IP) networks. A VTEP can have multiple VNI interfaces, but they associate with the same VTEP IP interface.
Software VTEP: Located on hypervisors using virtual switches.
Hardware VTEP: Located on routers/switches with ASICs for performance.
VTEP Interface: Connects to the underlay network, handles encapsulation.
VNI Interface: Virtual interface per segment (like SVI); handles segregation of Layer 2 domains.

MAC ADDRESS LEARNING
Each VTEP maintains a VXLAN mapping table linking destination MAC addresses to remote VTEP IPs.
Data plane: reactive, Flood and learn, MAC learned from incoming traffic, BUM via ingress replication or multicast underlay. No control-plane needed
Control plane: proactive, MP-BGP, BGP/VXLAN-MAC-to-VTEP advertised via BGP. No flooding needed for known MACs, ARP suppression, silent host handling
Flood and learn: Host H1 sends ARP request, switches learn H1's MAC. ARP request is flooded to H2 → H2 responds; switches learn H2's MAC.
Static VXLAN: Manual MAC-to-VTEP mappings. Sends copy of BUM traffic to all participating VTEPs. Doesn't scale well; BUM traffic is inefficient.
Multicast VXLAN: VTEPs join multicast groups per VNI. Scales better, offloads BUM replication. 20+ VTEPs = too much traffic, doesn't scale well
MP-BGP EVPN: Modern solution using BGP as control plane. Dynamically learns MAC/IP info.

ETHERNET VIRTUAL PRIVATE NETWORK (EVPN)
Overcome flood-and-learn limitations, doesn't rely on data plane learning, utilizes router control plane MP-BGP, works with different encapsulation techniques (VXLAN, MPLS), excellent scalability, L2 and L3 Support.

LAYER 2
L2 bridging across L3 networks
BGP Control Plane: Distributes MAC info (no flooding → efficiency)
VXLAN Overlay: Encapsulates L2 in L3 UDP (data plane)
Multi-Tenancy: via VNI segmentation
Redundancy: All-active multihoming, ECMP, fast convergence

USE CASES
– Multi-tenant datacenter interconnections (DCI)
– Extending L2 over WAN between remote sites
– Scalable, segmented L2 fabrics

AUTO-DISCOVERY VIA ROUTE REFLECTORS
– RR reflects EVPN routes to other PEs
– RR doesn't participate in EVPN or pseudowires
– RR needs only **address-family l2vpn evpn**
– L2VPN RIB stores endpoint/VFI info for control plane
– BGP UPDATE from spines contains **ORIGINATOR_ID** (origin leaf)

HOST DETECTION
Host connects to VTEP → MAC learned locally
– VTEP advertises MAC + L2VNI via BGP EVPN
– MAC learning follows normal Ethernet semantics

INGRESS REPLICATION (IR)
Forwarding BUM traffic. When Multicast underlay network is not used, IR handles multi-destination traffic (ARP → unicast). Ingress device replicates BUM packets, sends them as separate unicast to egress devices.

EARLY ARP DETECTION (SE)
– Avoids flooding ARP requests
– VTEP queries control plane for MAC/IP/VNI mapping
– If known → direct unicast (no broadcast)
Silent Host Flow (Fallback)
– If IP/MAC unknown → ARP sent via **ingress replication**
– Replicated ARP request goes to remote VTEPs
– Only correct host responds → update reflected to all VTEPs
– Future traffic uses updated BGP mapping

LAYER 3
By adding L3 features, data routing efficiency + smooth connections improve

EVPN ROUTE TYPES
1) Ethernet Auto-Discovery Route (3) Inclusive Multicast Route (4) Ethernet Segment Route (5) Inclusive Multicast Ethernet Tag Route (7) IGMP Join Synchrony Route (8) IGMP Leave Synchrony Route
Type 2 – Host Advertisement: Advertises host MAC (mandatory), optionally IP, along with L2VNI and optionally L3VNI. Used for MAC learning, ARP suppression, and host mobility. Sent when host connects to VTEP.

[2]: Route Type [0]: Eth. Segment ID [0]: Eth. Tag ID [48]: MAC Addr len [a2b9.4605.948d]: MAC [32]: IP Addr len [10.1.1.1]: IP

RT: L2VNI (VLAN) RT: L3VNI (VRF) Overlay Encapsulation: 8 - VXLAN L2VNI L3VNI Router MAC of Remote VTEP Remote VTEP IP

LEAF-SW show bwp l2vpn evpn 10.1.1.1
BGP routing table information for VRF default, address family L2VPN EVPN
Route Distinguisher: 10.0.0.3:32777
BGP routing table entry for [2]:[0]:[0]:[48]:[a2b9.4605.948d]:[32]:[10.1.1.1]/722, version 6421
Paths: (2 available, best #2)
Flags: (0x00002) on xmit-1st, is not in L2rib/evpn, is not in HW
Advertised path-id 1
Path type: Internal, path is valid, is best path, no labeled nexthop
AS-Path: NONE, path sourced internal to AS
10.0.1.101 (metric 81) from 10.0.0.1 (10.0.0.1)
Origin IGP, MED 0, LocalPref 100, weight 0
Received label 100010 100999
Extcommunity: RT:645080:100010 RT:645080:100999 ENCAP:8
Router MAC:00d0.0a00.0168
Originator: 10.0.0.3 Cluster List: 10.0.0.1

Type 5 – Subnet Advertisement: Advertises IP prefix + prefix length to L3VNI. Used for inter-subnet routing. VTEP redistributes connected/static/dynamic IP routes. Additional attributes: L3VNI, extended communities.

[5]: Route Type [0]: Eth. Segment ID [0]: Eth. Tag ID [24]: IP Pref. len [198.51.100.0]: IP Prefix [6.0.0.0]: GW IP

L3VNI RT: L3VNI (VLAN) Overlay Encapsulation: 8 - VXLAN Router MAC of Remote VTEP Remote VTEP IP

LEAF-SW show bwp l2vpn evpn route-type 5
BGP routing table information for VRF default, address family L2VPN EVPN
Route Distinguisher: 10.0.0.3:3
BGP routing table entry for [5]:[0]:[0]:[24]:[198.51.100.0]:[6.0.0.0]/224, version 6421
Paths: (2 available, best #2)
Flags: (0x00002) on xmit-1st, is not in L2rib/evpn, is not in HW
Advertised path-id 1
Path type: Internal, path is valid, not best reason: Neighbor
Address: no labeled nexthop
AS-Path: NONE, path sourced internal to AS
203.0.113.1 (metric 81) from 192.0.2.12 (192.0.2.2)
Origin incomplete, MED 0, LocalPref 100, weight 0
Received label 10001
Extcommunity: RT:645080:10001 Router MAC:00d0.0a00.0168
Originator: 192.0.2.3 Cluster List: 192.0.2.2

HOST DETECTION
– Host sends ARP/ND to local VTEP
– VTEP learns MAC/L2VNI and IP/L3VNI
– Info is advertised in EVPN (control plane)

HOST DELETION & EVPN
Host Deletion: When a host detaches, its ARP (default: 1500s) and MAC entry (default: 1800s) time out on the VTEP. Upon aging, the VTEP withdraws the host's MAC/L2VNI and IP/L3VNI advertisements.
Host Move: When a host moves to a new VTEP, the new VTEP advertises updated reachability with a higher move sequence number. The old VTEP withdraws its entry, completing the migration.

VIRTUAL ROUTING AND FORWARDING (VRF)
– Supports independent policies per tenant
– Key for scaling and multi-customer separation

DISTRIBUTED ANYCAST GATEWAY (DAG)
– Same gateway IP+MAC on all VTEPs

– Enables local default gateway for hosts in MPLS network with IRB
– Supports mobility + optimal forwarding across BGP EVPN fabric

INTEGRATED ROUTING AND BRIDGING (IRB)
– Enables inter-VLAN routing inside EVPN
– Avoids central gateway → "no traffic tromboning"

ASYMMETRIC IRB (L2)
– Routing only ingress, bridging on egress
– VXLAN uses destination VNI in both directions
– One L2 VNI per VLAN/Subnet
– Simple config, but requires all VLANs/VNIs on all VTEPs (scaling issues)

Leaf 1 (ingress) routes + bridges VNI 10010 VNI 10020
Spine
Leaf 2 (egress) bridges only VNI 10020
VM A VNI 10010
VXLAN encap L2 VNI 10020
VM B VNI 10020

1) VM A → Leaf 1 in VNI 10010 (frame to anycast gateway)
2) Leaf 1 routes locally. VNI 10010 → VNI 10020 (L3 lookup, MAC rewrite)
3) Leaf 1 encapsulates with destination L2 VNI 10020 → spine → Leaf 2
4) Leaf 2 decapsulates and bridges in VNI 10020 to VM B → no routing

SYMMETRIC IRB (L2 + L3)
– Routing/bridging on ingress + egress VTEPs
– Uses L3 Transit VNI (same in both directions), One L3 VNI per VRF (Tenant)
– Scales well, clear separation of MAC and IP
– Requires L3 connectivity between all destination VTEPs for Type 2 routing (Done by configuring Type 5 routing)

Leaf 1 (ingress) routes + bridges VNI 10010 VNI 50000
Spine
Leaf 2 (egress) bridges only VNI 50000 VNI 10020
VM A VNI 10010
VXLAN encap L3 VNI 50000
VM B VNI 10020

1) VM A → Leaf 1 in VNI 10010 (frame to anycast gateway)
2) Leaf 1 routes locally into the L3 VNI (tenant VRF transit)
3) Encapsulation carries the L3 VNI 50000 → Leaf 2
4) Leaf 2 decapsulates, looks up dest IP in the VRF, routes into VNI 10020
5) Leaf 2 bridges to VM B on the local subnet

MULTI-PROTOCOL BGP (MP-BGP)
Address Family Identifier (AFI): Category of information being carried
Subsequent AFI (SAFI): Narrows down the specific type within that category
EVPN NLRI: Uses MP-BGP with specific AFI/SAFI. Supports multiple route types and attributes, unsupported routes are dropped by BGP

– Enables protocol-based VTEP discovery and host reachability via control-plane learning. Reduces flooding by replacing data-plane learning
– Extends BGP with multiprotocol capabilities (AFI/SAFI)
– Uses **MP_REACH_NLRI** and **MP_UNREACH_NLRI** for route advertisement and withdrawal (advertises VPNv4 between PEs in MPLS)
– Uses the **VPNv4 NLRI** to distinguish between duplicate IPv4 prefixes

BGP CONTROL PLANE
– PEs learn MACs from local CE's (data plane)
– MACs advertised via BGP (control plane)
– Uses Route Distinguishers and MPLS labels
– Remote PEs update L2 RIB/FIB with MAC and next-hop info
– Enables seamless L2 across IP/MPLS backbone

CDN
Origin Server: Central content source (original files), usually in a datacenter
Edge / CDN Server: Also called **Point of Presence (POP)**. Geographically distributed, caches content
Embedded POP: Deployed directly inside ISP's local network
DNS Infrastructure: Directs users to optimal edge server (e.g. Geo-Routing)

KEY BENEFITS
Latency Reduction: Nearby edge servers reduce round-trip time
Availability: Failover and redundancy in case of node failure
Scalability: Handles traffic spikes via load balancing
Cost Optimization: Reduces backend and transit load on origin
DDoS Protection: Edge servers absorb attacks → not all traffic on one server
Global Load Reduction: Less long-distance traffic across the Internet

REQUEST ROUTING TECHNIQUES
– Decides which edge server should serve a client request
– Goal: Best performance (e.g. proximity, load, responsiveness)

DNS-BASED GEO-ROUTING
– Each edge has a unique IP
– DNS server picks closest/optimal edge server based on:
– Resolver IP/location (not user) → can cause wrong choice
– DNS (MaxMind, IP2Location), load, latency, business rules
– **EDNS0** and **Client Subnet Extension (ECS):**
– Resolver includes part of client IP in DNS request (e.g. /24 subnet)
– Authoritative DNS makes better decision based on actual client region
– Improves accuracy without revealing full IP, increases caching complexity

ANYCAST WITH BGP
– Same IP (e.g. 7.7.7.7) advertised from multiple locations
– BGP routing decides which path is "best" (AS-path, local pref, etc.)
– No DNS logic or per-client decision – pure BGP convergence
– **Pros:** Fast failover, simple, no app logic needed
– **Cons:** Control BGP, BGP + best latency, route flapping risk

MANAGING TRAFFIC
Anycast: Modify BGP attributes/withdraw IP prefix. Not precise
Software: Shifting via Encapsulation tunnels (GRE)

LOAD BALANCING
Load balancing device: Efficient, reliable, High cost, single point of failure
ECMP: ToF router balances traffic. Simple, cheap, Adding/removing server changes hashing pool, re-hashing breaks TCP connections if: GRE tunnel

HTTP CACHING & HEADERS
Caching is controlled via HTTP headers between clients, proxies, and servers
Cache-Control: Main directive (**no-cache, no-store, max-age, must-revalidate, etc.**)
Expires: Absolute expiration time (older method, replaced by **Cache-Control**)
ETag: Validator tag (version/hash), used with **If-None-Match**
Last-Modified: Timestamp used with **If-Modified-Since** for validation
Age: Time (in seconds) since response was fetched from origin
Validation: Client uses **ETag** or **Last-Modified**; server → 304 if unchanged

QoS
Internet is best effort: No guarantees, no QoS; all traffic treated equally (net neutrality); simple, scalable, but no delivery/order assurance or prioritization
Quality of Experience (QoE): Perceived service quality from user perspective
Queue Pining: Keeps flow on a fixed path to prevent oscillation (don't switch immediately to "better" path)
Routing-based: Path selection; QoS-aware routing; Choose best path
Node-based: Packet treatment; Congestion mgmt; queuing/scheduling/policing/shaping; "What happens to packets at each hop?"
PAK-Priority: System queues (routers) that prioritizes routing protocol packets

4-Class Model

4-Class Model	8-Class Model	12-Class Model
Real Time	Voice	Voice
	Interactive Video	Real-Time Interactive
		Multimedia Conferencing
	Streaming Video	Broadcast Video
		Multimedia Streaming
Signaling or Control	Signaling	Signaling
	Network Control	Network Control
		Network Management
Critical Data	Critical Data	Transactional Data
		Bulk Data
Best Effort	Best Effort	Best Effort
	Scavenger	Scavenger

NETWORK PERFORMANCE METRICS
Bandwidth [Gbit/s]: Maximum transfer capacity of a link (width of pipe)
Throughput [Gbit/s]: Successfully delivered data (water that reached dest)
Latency / Delay [ms]: Time for packets to travel src → dest (length of pipe)
End-to-End Delay: Total time sender to receiver
One-Way Delay: From first bit sent to last bit received
Component: Transmission delay (time to push onto link), **Processing delay** (lookup, queuing), **Propagation delay** (physical travel time)
Jitter [ms]: Variation in delay between packets, caused by re-routing/queuing (Voip>30ms), Calc: highest - lowest delay. Doesn't impact TCP
Packet Loss Ratio (PLR) [%]: Dropped packets due to congestion or errors

QUEUEING
Incoming buffer: Usually only transit, cannot be filled up in case of a CPU overload; leads to drops
Outgoing buffer: Filled up with packets waiting for transmission, queue management is focused on the outgoing buffer

ALGORITHMS
First-In-First-Out (FIFO): Basic, no prioritization
Priority Queuing (PQ): Multiple queues, serve highest first; others may starve
Round-Robin (RR): One packet per queue in turn (fair, but ignores priority)
Weighted Fair Queuing (WFQ): RR with weights, n packets per queue
Class-Based WFQ (CBWFQ): WFQ with user-defined classes (logical queues), queues limits, max bandwidth guaranteed or max % of bandwidth
Low Latency Queuing (LLQ): Adds strict priority queue (priority class) to CBWFQ for delay-sensitive traffic (e.g. voice) (based on IP Precedence, DSCP, src, port, protocol...)

QUEUE MANAGEMENT
tail Drop: Drops packets when queue full; huge interruption of traffic → same as no connectivity
TCP Global Sync: Many TCP flows back off and restart simultaneously (AIMD) → link underutilization
TCP Starvation: TCP slows down after drops (congestion control), UDP doesn't → queues filled with UDP TCP squeezed out
Random Early Detection (RED): Random early drops before full queue to prevent global sync and TCP collapse. Dropped TCP segments cause TCP sessions to reduce their window sizes
Weighted RED (WRED): RED + DSCP/EXP-based drop logic, prioritizes higher-marked traffic, max thresh → all packets dropped

POLICING VS. SHAPING
Policing (Inbound mostly): Drops packets that exceed configured rate limits
Shaping (Outbound): Buffers packets to smooth traffic bursts

QoS MODELS
BEST EFFORT
No guarantees, all traffic treated equally (follow Internet neutrality)
INTEGRATED SERVICES (INTSERV)
– End-to-end QoS (guaranteed for specific apps)
– Per-flow resource reservation
– Precise but not scalable (uses RSVP)
– App informs network of traffic traits, requests service before sending data
DIFFERENTIATED SERVICES (DIFFSERV)
– Scalable approach using marking. No hard guarantees, Cost-effective
– Divides traffic into classes based on business requirements
– Routers are configured with policy on how to prioritize classes
Marking (DSCP)
Differentiated Services Code Point (DSCP): 6-bit field in the IP header used to classify and manage network traffic
L3 Marking: ToS byte → DSCP (6 bits) + IP Precedence (3 bits) [overlapping]
DSCP: (6-bit in IP header) marks packets for QoS; classifies traffic
L2 Marking: Dot1q header → 802.1p/CoS bits
EXP: (3-bit in MPLS label) serves same purpose within MPLS networks; often mapped from DSCP

Behavior (PHB)
Per-Hop Behavior (PHB): Defines what routers actually do
Class Selector (CS): Compat with old IP Precedence, simple prio levels
Assured Forwarding (AF): Multiple classes + drop priorities
Expedited Forwarding (EF): Very high prio, e.g. VoIP

MODULAR QoS CLI (MQC)
Class Map: Define traffic classes (e.g., match voice or video)
Policy Map: Define actions for each class (e.g., limit, shape, priority)
Service Policy: Apply policies to interfaces or directions (in/out)

OTHER INFOS
AD: Inter-protocol choice (e.g., OSPF vs RIP) → lower wins
Cost/Metric: Intra-protocol choice (e.g., OSPF path A vs B) → lower wins
Routing Preference Order (across protocols):
– Most specific prefix
– Lowest Administrative Distance
– Static default route
Administrative Distances: (Smallest Administrative Distance wins)

	Protocol	Distance
Connected	0	
Static (next hop)	1	
BGP External	20	
OSPF Internal	90	
EIGRP	110	
ISIS	115	
RIP v1/v2	120	
EIGRP External	170	
BGP Internal	200	